



ZAY-MARIE PRESS

Passage Study Worksheet Pack

Reusable forms for evidence based Bible study

FREE STUDY AND REFERENCE RESOURCE

Where the Bible Means What It Says

Observe • Interpret • Assign • Apply

How to Use This Pack

This pack provides reusable forms for a short biblical paragraph or complete unit of thought. It is designed for readers who understand the basic sequence of observation, meaning, assignment, and application and want structured space to practice that sequence consistently.

The forms are intentionally simplified. They do not replace a full evidence ledger, literary analysis, canonical-correlation study, programmatic diagnostic, competing-interpretation analysis, or comprehensive exegesis. Use only the pages a passage materially requires, but complete the final review before settling your conclusion.

Worksheet Sequence

Worksheet	Purpose
1 Passage Boundaries	Define the unit and record why it belongs together.
2 Observation Record	Separate direct textual observations from early questions.
3 Context Record	Locate the passage within its surrounding thought and biblical book.
4 Communication Setting	Identify speaker or writer, audience, occasion, and purpose.
5 Meaning and Evidence	State an interpretation and identify its strongest support.
6 Assignment and Application	Determine direct assignment and classify application.
7 Interpretation Review	Test the completed study for common errors.
8 Passage Study Summary	Present the final conclusion and its boundaries.

For introductory instruction and a worked example, use the free Biblical Interpretation Starter Kit available from Zay-Marie Press.

1 Passage Boundaries

Selected passage:

Where does the unit begin and end?

What words, subject, scene, speaker, argument, or literary features hold the unit together?

What immediately precedes this unit?

What immediately follows this unit?

- ☐ I selected a complete thought rather than an isolated phrase.
- ☐ I read enough surrounding Scripture to identify the developing subject.
- ☐ I treated chapter and verse divisions as editorial aids rather than inspired boundaries.

2 Observation Record

Record only what can be identified directly from the passage. Do not explain significance yet.

Textual feature	Direct observation
People or groups	
Actions or responses	
Repeated words or ideas	
Commands, promises, or warnings	
Contrasts or comparisons	
Questions and answers	
Connecting words	
Time, place, or sequence	
Stated reason or purpose	

Questions Raised by Observation

3 Context Record

Context level	Evidence and contribution
Selected passage	What is the principal subject and developing thought?
Surrounding passage	What do the nearby verses explain, qualify, support, or apply?
Larger section	How does the passage function within the larger argument or narrative?
Biblical book	How does it serve the book's audience, occasion, purpose, or message?

Context Notes

One interpretation that the context rules out or materially qualifies:

4 Communication Setting

Speaker or writer and evidence

Direct audience and evidence

Other people present but not necessarily addressed

Occasion or circumstances established by Scripture

Purpose evident in the passage

- ☐ I did not assume that everyone present is directly addressed.
- ☐ I distinguished the speaker's identity from the passage's assignment.
- ☐ I separated information supplied by Scripture from external reconstruction.

5 Meaning and Evidence

Principal subject:

What the passage communicates about that subject:

Meaning statement in one paragraph:

Three strongest pieces of textual or contextual evidence:

1.

2.

3.

One inference that should be identified rather than treated as explicit:

6 Assignment and Application

Direct audience or governing assignment:

Identity, promise, commission, obligation, or authority involved:

Evidence supporting the assignment:

Application Classification

- ☐ Direct governing application
- ☐ Principled application
- ☐ Historical or doctrinal instruction
- ☐ Illegitimate programmatic transfer

Proposed legitimate application and explanation:

A transfer or misapplication to avoid:

7 Interpretation Review

- ☐ I interpreted a complete unit of thought rather than an isolated phrase.
- ☐ My conclusion accounts for the words, relationships, and flow of the passage.
- ☐ I distinguished direct observation from inference.
- ☐ I used the immediate and broader context.
- ☐ I identified speaker or writer, audience, occasion, and purpose from evidence.
- ☐ I did not classify the passage merely because of the speaker or writer.
- ☐ I established meaning before determining assignment.
- ☐ I determined assignment before proposing application.
- ☐ My application preserves the passage's meaning and direct assignment.
- ☐ I identified at least one question that requires additional evidence.
- ☐ I have not treated a possible conclusion as though Scripture states it explicitly.
- ☐ My level of confidence is proportional to the evidence.

Correction Record

The most important weakness discovered during review:

Correction made to the interpretation or application:

8 Passage Study Summary

Passage:

Central interpretation:

Controlling evidence:

Assignment conclusion:

Legitimate application and category:

Interpretive boundary—what this passage does not establish by itself:

Question for further study:

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